

Professional statement outline

To develop a professional statement that briefly explains who you are and what you are passionate about, follow the steps outlined.

Note: You will need a piece of paper or a blank word processing document to complete this activity

Step one

List two to three strengths that you currently have or are committed to developing (e.g., strong written and verbal communication, time management, programming, etc.).

Having an inventory of your strengths can help you create your professional statement. It may also encourage you to focus on skills you want to develop as you progress through the certificate program.

Step two

List one to two values you have (e.g., protecting organizations, protecting people, adhering to laws, ensuring equitable access, etc.).

Establishing your values can help you and a prospective employer determine if your goals are aligned. Ensure that you are representing yourself accurately, and be honest about what motivates you.

Step three

Ask yourself some **clarifying questions** to determine what to include in your professional statement:

1. What most interests me about the field of cybersecurity?
2. Who is the audience for my professional statement (e.g., cybersecurity recruiters, specific organizations, government employers, etc.)?
3. In what ways can my strengths, values, and interest in cybersecurity support the security goals of various organizations?

Note: This is just a draft. You should continue to revise and refine your professional statement, throughout the program, until you feel that it's ready to share with potential employers.

My strengths

Strong analytical thinking and problem-solving

Detail-oriented and methodical approach to technical work

Growing skills in **Linux**, **SQL**, and cybersecurity fundamentals

Commitment to learning and improving (Security+, Network+, CEH goals)

Clear written communication (your cheat sheet work proves this)

My values

Protecting people and organizations from cyber threats

Ensuring systems are secure, reliable, and ethical

Following laws, frameworks, and best practices

Continuous learning and professional growth

Questions

1. What interests you most about cybersecurity?

You're interested in:

- Understanding how systems work
- Protecting data and preventing attacks
- Hands-on technical work (Linux, networks, SIEM, vulnerabilities)
- Building a strong foundation for a SOC or analyst role

2. Who is the audience?

Your audience is:

- Cybersecurity recruiters
- SOC analyst hiring managers
- IT/security teams at companies
- Organizations looking for motivated entry-level analysts

3. How do your strengths + values support security goals?

- Your detail-oriented mindset helps identify vulnerabilities
- Your communication skills help document incidents clearly
- Your technical curiosity helps you learn tools quickly
- Your values align with protecting users, data, and systems
- Your commitment to certifications shows long-term dedication

Draft of professional statement

I am a detail-oriented cybersecurity student with strong analytical skills and a growing foundation in Linux, networking, and security tools. I'm passionate about protecting people and organizations by identifying vulnerabilities, strengthening defenses, and following ethical and industry-standard best practices. I value continuous learning and am actively preparing for certifications like Security+ and CEH to deepen my technical abilities. My goal is to contribute to a security team where I can apply my skills, support organizational security goals, and continue developing as a cybersecurity professional.